Overview

The Unified Modeling Language is a visual language for describing the structure and behaviour of software systems.

Class diagrams

Show classes, their attributes and operations, and the relationships between them: association, aggregation, composition and inheritance.

Use case diagrams

Show actors and the goals they achieve with the system. They are a good starting point for discussing scope with stakeholders.

Sequence diagrams

Show how objects interact over time by exchanging messages. Use them to clarify the flow of a single scenario.

Choosing a diagram

Pick the diagram that answers the question at hand. Do not model everything: model what helps the team decide.